Event ID / Rule - What It Means - When to Use It

DG Interns Hub - Week 3 | Hands-On Task 6: Cheat Sheet

Name: Harini E | Intern ID: DG/15/OCT/CYBER/040

I put this sheet together as a quick reference for the events and rules I worked with this week on Windows, Linux and the network. Each row says what the entry means and the situation where I would look at it first as a SOC analyst. I generated several of them myself in my lab: Sysmon 1, 3 and 11, auditd EXECVE, and the four Snort rules.

Event ID / Rule	Source	What It Means	When to Use It
4624	Windows Security	A successful logon. The logon type tells how the user signed in (console, network, remote desktop).	Separating normal logins from unusual ones, such as a login at a strange hour or from an unexpected machine, and tracing lateral movement.
4625	Windows Security	A failed logon attempt.	Spotting brute force and password spraying (T1110). Many 4625 events for one account or from one source is the pattern to look for.
4688	Windows Security	A new process was created. Shows the command line only when command line auditing is turned on.	Tracking which programs ran, and by whom, when Sysmon is not available.
4720	Windows Security	A new user account was created.	Catching persistence through new accounts (T1136). Any unplanned 4720 deserves a check.
4672	Windows Security	An account that holds special privileges logged on, which usually means an administrator level account.	Watching privileged account use, and checking whether an account that should not be an administrator is logging in with admin rights.
1102	Windows Security	The audit log was cleared.	Detecting an attacker covering their tracks (T1070.001). I saw this in Week 2 after clearing my own lab log.
1	Sysmon	Process Create. Records the Image, CommandLine, parent process, user and file hashes.	Monitoring process execution, such as PowerShell or net.exe, and spotting suspicious command lines.
3	Sysmon	Network Connection. Links a connection to the process that made it, with source and destination IP and port.	Detecting command and control traffic or lateral movement from an unusual process.
11	Sysmon	File Create. Shows which process created a file and where.	Finding dropped files in folders like Downloads, Temp or Startup. My test file only logged from Downloads.
22	Sysmon	DNS Query. Records the domain a process looked up.	Detecting DNS based command and control and unusual domain lookups.
13	Sysmon	Registry Value Set. Records a change to a registry value and the process behind it.	Finding persistence set up through registry keys such as Run keys.

Event ID / Rule	Source	What It Means	When to Use It
EXECVE	Linux auditd	Records the command and its arguments when a program is executed.	Auditing Linux commands. I used it to find apt install nano (a0=apt, a1=install, a2=nano).
USER_LOGIN	Linux auditd	A user login event, with the result of the attempt.	Tracking who logged in to the Linux system and from where.
USER_AUTH	Linux auditd	An authentication attempt, with success or failure.	Detecting failed logins and repeated password guessing on Linux.
CONFIG_CHANGE	Linux auditd	A change to the audit configuration, for example a rule added (op=add_rule).	Noticing when audit rules are changed, since attackers may try to switch auditing off.
1000001	Snort	ICMP Ping Detected. Fires on ICMP traffic sent to my home network.	Detecting network reconnaissance, such as a host sweep with ping.
1000002	Snort	SSH Connection Attempt. Fires on TCP traffic to port 22.	Monitoring SSH access to the server and watching for repeated attempts.
1000003	Snort	HTTP Traffic. Fires on TCP traffic to port 80.	Monitoring web traffic to a server.
1000004	Snort	Nmap SYN Scan Detected (MITRE T1046). Fires when one source sends 20 SYN packets within 1 second, using detection_filter in Snort 3.	Detecting port scanning and network service discovery. It alerted when I ran nmap -sS from Kali.

A note on the Snort entries

Ubuntu 26.04 had no Snort package, so I built Snort 3 from source. In Snort 3 the threshold option is not supported inside a rule, so rule 1000004 uses detection_filter with the same count and time. I also set the rule source to any, because my Kali machine sits inside HOME_NET. These were the only changes I made to the rules from the task sheet.